

■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Thursday, July 09, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (0 stories)

(no core-fit candidates scored high enough today)

TRENDING TODAY

■ **Justin Baldoni breaks silence on Blake Lively feud and lawsuits**

The Angle: After weeks of legal back-and-forth, Justin Baldoni and his wife Emily are finally going on record about the *It Ends With Us* drama—and they're calling out what they see as injustice. This is the first time he's publicly responded since Blake Lively's accusations went public.

- **Justin Baldoni** stars in and directed **It Ends With Us**, the domestic-violence drama that sparked the feud with co-star **Blake Lively**
- Baldoni says he can **finally speak out** about the **bitter feud** after remaining silent through earlier legal filings
- **Emily Baldoni** appeared alongside **Justin** in the video response, framing the situation as involving **'painful things'** and **'injustice'**

The Hollywood Blame Game

- Who do you actually believe here—and does it change how you feel about watching the movie?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/entertainment/justin-baldoni-instagram-blake-lively-lawsuit-9.7264061?cmp=rss>

LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ **Katie Couric's sudden memory loss — what doctors say happened**

The Angle: Katie Couric just opened up about a scary health episode that left her unable to remember basic details. It's a real condition that can happen to anyone — and she's using her platform to raise awareness about what doctors think triggered it.

- **Katie Couric** experienced a bout of temporary amnesia she described as **'freaky'**
- The incident was significant enough that Couric felt compelled to publicly share the details and seek medical explanations

The Health Deep Dive

- Have you ever had a moment where your memory just blanked out completely — and it scared you? Couric's opening up about hers.

KAMR - MyHighPlains.com (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 73/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 16 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.myhighplains.com/news/national/katie-couric-diagnosed-with-temporary-amnesia-in-freaky-health-scare-what-is-it/>

Backup options:

■ **Ariana Madix lands first Emmy nod hosting Love Island USA**

The Angle: The *Vanderpump Rules* star broke through to Emmy recognition for her work on Peacock's dating show—a career pivot that's clearly paying off in a big way.

- **Ariana Madix** earned her **first-ever Emmy nomination** as host of **Love Island USA** on **Peacock**
- She took over hosting duties in **Season 6**, replacing previous host **Sarah Hyland**
- The nomination comes after her long run on **Vanderpump Rules**, marking a significant shift into hosting

The Pivot Play

- How many of you actually watch Love Island USA—and did you know Ariana was hosting it?

Deadline (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 73/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 16 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <http://deadline.com/2026/07/ariana-madix-emmy-nomination-love-island-usa-host-1236977052/>

■ **The male feminist paradox—what the research actually says**

***The Angle:** A viral hot-take is sparking the age-old debate about performative allyship versus genuine commitment. It's the kind of culture-war needle that gets people fired up on both sides, and honestly, there's real psychology buried in here worth unpacking.*

The Call-Out

- Are you dating or working with someone who talks the talk on gender equality but doesn't walk the walk—and how would you even know?

X/Twitter @WomenBeingAwful (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://x.com/WomenBeingAwful/status/2075292357772128680>

CLOSER: THROWBACK THURSDAY

■ **Sarah McLachlan and Allison Russell Hit the Road Together This Summer**

***The Angle:** Two powerhouse vocalists are joining forces for a co-headlining tour that's part nostalgia lap, part fresh collaboration. It's the kind of summer lineup that appeals to both longtime fans and newer listeners looking for serious songwriting credentials.*

- **Sarah McLachlan** is touring behind her 2025 album **"Better Broken"** following the success of her **"Fumbling Towards Ecstasy" 30th Anniversary Tour**
- **Allison Russell** is the co-headliner, creating what McLachlan calls a **"sister-y road show"** for summer dates
- The tour blends commemorative elements from McLachlan's anniversary run with new material and a collaborative energy between the two artists

The Nostalgia Check-In

- Are you a die-hard McLachlan fan from the '90s, or is Allison Russell your gateway into this tour—and does it matter?

variety.com (Tier 2) | Score: 44/90 (40 fit + 8 source + 21 quality - 25 penalty (used within the last 30 days)) -> BACKUP

URL: <https://variety.com/2026/music/news/sarah-mclachlan-tour-allison-russell-joint-interview-1236806144/>

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 0/3 this month; TECH TALK 2/2 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 4/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■ **Raptors put blockbuster Kawhi Leonard trade on hold pending conclusion of NBA's probe**

***The Angle:** Raptors put blockbuster Kawhi Leonard trade on hold pending conclusion of NBA's probe*

■ **Turkey gifts NATO leaders loaded revolvers. Canada fires back with syrup.**

The Angle: At a major NATO summit in Ankara, Turkish President Erdoğan handed every alliance leader a .357 magnum revolver as a parting gift—a move that caught Canada's new PM Mark Carney completely off-guard. His response? Maple syrup. It's the kind of diplomatic moment that's equal parts awkward and hilarious.

- Turkish President Recep Tayyip Erdoğan gave every NATO leader at the Ankara summit a .357 magnum revolver
- Prime Minister Mark Carney called the gift "not what I expected"
- Canada responded by gifting Erdoğan maple syrup in return

The Diplomatic Head-Scratcher

- What's the weirdest gift you've ever received from someone in a position of power, and how did you handle it?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: The Setup** - 30 seconds -> Hosts riff on the initial absurdity: a NATO summit, Erdoğan handing out literal weapons like party favors. Carney's stunned reaction.
- **Step 2: The Clap Back** - 45 seconds -> Hosts laugh at Canada's counter-move—syrup. Play up the contrast: revolver vs. pancake toppings. Is that peak Canadian diplomacy or just deflecting?
- **Step 3: The Phone Line** - 2-3 minutes -> Open lines: listeners share their worst/weirdest gifts from bosses, politicians, or authority figures. Or: what would YOU have gifted back?
- **Step 4: The Take** - 1 minute -> Hosts wrap with a thought on what this says about Erdoğan, NATO unity, or Canadian diplomacy—serious note under the comedy.

■ ■ **Vicious storm in central Alberta results in 2 tornadoes, sends 3 people to hospital**

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■ **Alberta RCMP issues Amber Alert for missing six-year-old boy**

The Angle: Police in Alberta have activated an Amber Alert for a six-year-old taken on Tuesday. The child may be with his mother and two other individuals, and authorities are asking the public for help locating them.

- Lanakai Morrison, age 6, was taken on Tuesday in Alberta
- He may be travelling with his mother Krista Morrison, 35, and two other individuals: Daniel Ludwig, 35, and Karl Morrison, 4
- Alberta RCMP issued an Amber Alert to help locate the child

The Public Call-Out

- If you're in Alberta or nearby and spot this child or the people he's with, you've got critical information—what would you do?

■ **LGBTQ+ cruise ship blocked by two countries in one week**

The Angle: A charter cruise catering to 2SLGBTQ+ travelers has now been turned away by both Turkey and Egypt—raising questions about discrimination, religious/cultural politics, and what rights cruise lines actually have when countries deny port access.

- The **Scarlet Lady**, chartered by **Atlantis Events** (a 2SLGBTQ+ travel company), was denied entry to **Turkey** first, then **Egypt**, forcing two route changes in a single week
- This marks the second time in days that Middle Eastern/Mediterranean nations have blocked the same vessel from docking

The Rights & Pushback

- Should countries have the right to turn away a cruise ship based on the passengers' identity—or is this straight-up discrimination that the travel industry needs to fight back on?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/2slgbtq-cruise-denied-entry-turkey-egypt-9.7264048?cmp=rss>

■ **4 men cuffed after Durham cops seize guns; serial break-ins allegedly foiled**

The Angle: 4 men cuffed after Durham cops seize guns; serial break-ins allegedly foiled

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://torontosun.com/news/local-news/men-cuffed-durham-weapon-trafficking-bust>

■ **JAY GOLDBERG: Mark Carney wants your trust, not your questions**

The Angle: JAY GOLDBERG: Mark Carney wants your trust, not your questions

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://torontosun.com/opinion/columnists/jay-goldberg-mark-carney-wants-your-trust-not-your-questions>

■ **LILLEY: If Mark Carney can avoid lecturing Saudi Arabia, why not Donald Trump?**

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torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://torontosun.com/opinion/columnists/mark-carney-stop-lecturing-donald-trump>

■ **Hofstra star pitcher hoping to get selected on 'first day' of MLB draft**

The Angle: Hofstra star pitcher hoping to get selected on 'first day' of MLB draft

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://nypost.com/2026/07/09/sports/hofstra-star-pitcher-hoping-to-get-selected-on-first-day-of-mlb-draft/>

🚨 ■ **Wild footage shows violent brawl erupt after drunken passengers were thrown off flight at Mexico City airport**

The Angle: Wild footage shows violent brawl erupt after drunken passengers were thrown off flight at Mexico City airport

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://nypost.com/2026/07/09/world-news/wild-footage-shows-violent-brawl-erupt-after-drunken-passengers-were-thrown-off-flight-at-mexico-city-airport/>

■ **'RHOC' star Jennifer Pedranti breaks silence on son's brush fire drama**

The Angle: 'RHOC' star Jennifer Pedranti breaks silence on son's brush fire drama

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://nypost.com/2026/07/09/us-news/jennifer-pedranti-addresses-rumors-son-started-ladera-ranch-brush-fire/>

■ **Breaking down what USMNT's 2030 World Cup roster could look like**

The Angle: Breaking down what USMNT's 2030 World Cup roster could look like

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://nypost.com/2026/07/09/sports/breaking-down-what-usmnts-2030-world-cup-roster-could-look-like/>

■ **Cubs manager Craig Counsell rips 'illogical' replay review in club's loss**

The Angle: Cubs manager Craig Counsell rips 'illogical' replay review in club's loss

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://nypost.com/2026/07/09/sports/cubs-manager-craig-counsell-rips-illogical-replay-review/>

BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

■ **Israel warns U.S. of Iranian assassination plot against Trump**

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Iran assassination plot against Trump is a geopolitical bombshell with immediate national security implications that typically triggers major follow-up coverage and debate.

The Angle: Fresh intelligence sharing between Israel and U.S. agencies surfaces a reported Iranian threat targeting the former president—raising questions about cross-border intelligence operations and how seriously these threats are being treated heading into an election year.

- Israel shared intelligence with the U.S. detailing an alleged Iranian plot to assassinate Trump
- Intelligence was passed through official channels between the two allies
- The threat surfaces amid elevated tensions over Iran's regional activities and U.S. election security

The Hot Take

- Should voters be hearing more about foreign threats to U.S. political figures during an election cycle, or does that cross a line?

X/Twitter @CTVNews (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://x.com/CTVNews/status/2075371975959036200>

■ **Hurricanes owner's decision to put seven family members on Stanley Cup mocked online <https://t.co/pq2zqkWGeV>**

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Stanley Cup family controversy has already started gaining organic mockery online, suggesting emergent cultural pushback momentum that tends to accelerate once mainstream sports media picks it up.

The Angle: Hurricanes owner's decision to put seven family members on Stanley Cup mocked online <https://t.co/pq2zqkWGeV>

X/Twitter @CTVNews (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://x.com/CTVNews/status/2075316760446689324>

■ **The Live-Action 'Naruto' Movie Is Finally Happening, for Real <https://t.co/woGdfsSEfg>**

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Live-action Naruto movie finally greenlit after years of false starts hits a massive fanbase that's been waiting for this specific announcement and will likely drive discovery retroactively.

The Angle: The Live-Action 'Naruto' Movie Is Finally Happening, for Real <https://t.co/woGdfsSEfg>

X/Twitter @Gizmodo (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://x.com/Gizmodo/status/2075353076559433838>

■ **PM Carney felt his maple syrup gift 'undermatched' the engraved pistol Erdogan gave him in return** <https://t.co/g3lt6fFiue>

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): The maple syrup/pistol gift exchange between Carney and Erdogan is absurdly specific and meme-able in a way that could spread rapidly once it hits the right social contexts.

The Angle: *PM Carney felt his maple syrup gift 'undermatched' the engraved pistol Erdogan gave him in return* <https://t.co/g3lt6fFiue>

X/Twitter @CTVNews (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://x.com/CTVNews/status/2075283957805920396>

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 1 banked (+15 each when found)

- "Meta Begins Data Center Invasion of Canada, Which Reminds Me of Some Weird Zuck Trivia" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-07-09)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 4 banked (+15 each when found)

- "Wes Anderson Was Trapped in Academy Museum Elevator After 'Bottle Rocket' Anniversary Event" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-07-08)

- "'Rent' West End Revival Reveals Cast Joining Gaten Matarazzo: Travis Ross as Roger, Bella Brown as Mimi and More" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-08)

- "The #Rent musical revival in London's West End has announced its cast:" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-07-08)

- "JENNIE and Rosalía L.O.L. Surprise! O.M.G Dolls: 10th Anniversary Collectibles" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-07-08)

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- r/upliftingnews (fetch failed or rate-limited)

- r/nottheonion (fetch failed or rate-limited)

- r/technology (fetch failed or rate-limited)

- r/futurology (fetch failed or rate-limited)

- r/science (fetch failed or rate-limited)

- r/canada (fetch failed or rate-limited)

- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 100+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)

- 17 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-07-09 11:57 PM